

Thai Lime Cheesecake Bars

with Cardamom–Graham Cracker Crust

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Dreaming of Key lime pie, Chef Shanna created cheesecake bars that (we think) are even better. She steeps Thai lime leaves in fresh lime juice, then folds in cream cheese and condensed milk for a silky smooth filling. The graham cracker crust is flavored with cardamom and bound with coconut oil—a fun twist on the all-butter version. Let these chill for an hour (if you can wait that long), then devour.

SERVING SIZE	**4** *servings*
PREP & COOK TIME	**45–55** *minutes*
COOKING SKILL	**Easy**



BY CHEF SHANNA

CALORIES	PROTEIN	TOTAL CARB	TOTAL FAT
730	13g	83g	41g

Given the cook-at-home nature of Plated and natural variation in ingredients, nutritional information is approximated. See details.

Ingredients & Equipment

WHAT WE SEND


4 ounces
cream cheese


4
limes


2
Thai lime leaves


5 packets
coconut oil


1 cup
graham cracker crumbs


1/2 teaspoon
ground cardamom


3 cans
condensed milk


1
parchment paper


1
aluminum tin

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

eggs, kosher salt, baking sheet

ALLERGENS

soy, egg, milk, tree nuts, wheat

Cooking Steps



1. **Prepare ingredients**
   Preheat oven to 350°F. Set **cream cheese** aside to soften at room temperature. Reshape **aluminum tin**, if bent. Trim **parchment paper** to overlap edges of tin by about 1 inch; add to tin, creasing edges as needed to ensure a tight fit.



2. **Prepare ingredients**
   Rinse all produce. If you have a zester, zest **up to 2 limes**, then halve **limes**. Reserve **2 teaspoons lime zest** (if using) in a small bowl for garnish. Juice **limes** over a liquid measuring cup to yield ⅓ **cup juice**. Using your hands, crush **lime leaves** and add to juice. Place **coconut oil** in a large heatproof bowl. Microwave in 30-second intervals until completely melted.



3. **Make graham cracker crust**
   To bowl with melted coconut oil, add **graham cracker crumbs**, **cardamom**, and ¼ **teaspoon salt** and stir to combine. Press **graham cracker mixture** into bottom of prepared tin in an even layer. Place **tin** on a baking sheet (for easy transfer to oven and even baking). Bake until crust is golden and set, 8-10 minutes. Wipe bowl clean for the next step.



4. **Make cheesecake filling**
   While crust bakes, to bowl from graham cracker mixture, add **softened cream cheese** and whisk vigorously until smooth and creamy, 3-4 minutes. Add **condensed milk** and whisk to combine. Separate **2 eggs**, placing **yolks** in bowl with cream cheese mixture. Remove and discard **lime leaves** from juice and add to bowl, along with **remaining lime zest**, if using (not 2 teaspoons reserved). Whisk until smooth.



5. **Bake cheesecake bars**
   Once graham cracker crust is baked, pour over **cheesecake filling** and spread in an even layer. Bake until set but not browned, 15-17 minutes. (This is a great time to get ahead on dishes.) Then, transfer **tin** to freezer and chill until completely cool, about 1 hour.



6. **Plate Thai lime cheesecake bars**
   Once cheesecake is set, carefully transfer to a cutting board by lifting overlapping parchment. Cut **Thai lime cheesecake** into 2-inch squares and sprinkle over **reserved lime zest** (if using). Enjoy!